Jack Flay

Name: A Date: 10/20/26

002C.3 — Tuesday October 20 — New Monarchies: Four Country Cases

DO NOW — Name one way kings strengthened their power and one limit on it.

Pikemen, alliances.

THE HOLY ROMAN EMPIRE

1. The Holy Roman Empire's political core lay in German-speaking central Europe. The Habsburg dynasty also accumulated major dynastic lands outside the Empire through inheritance and marriage.

2. In the 1450s, Germany was not a nation-state like it is today. The Empire contained many territories ruled by many different rulers. This was one reason why the emperor's central authority was limited.

3. The Habsburg family grew in power largely through political alliances, inheritance, and strategic marriages. Under Charles V in the sixteenth century, the emperor combined the imperial title with extensive Habsburg dynastic possessions, making the dynasty exceptionally powerful without turning the Empire into a centralized state.

4. Habsburg rulers supplied Holy Roman emperors almost continuously from 1440 to 1740; after a brief interruption, the Habsburg-Lorraine line held the imperial title from 1745 until the Empire ended in 1806.



SPAIN

1. In 1469, Ferdinand of Aragon and Isabella of Castile married, creating a dynastic union. Castile and Aragon continued to possess separate laws and institutions, so this was not yet a single centralized "kingdom of Spain."

2. Ferdinand and Isabella strengthened royal government and pursued Catholic religious uniformity. The Spanish Inquisition, established under royal sponsorship in 1478, had jurisdiction over baptized Christians suspected of heresy, including conversos accused of secretly practicing Judaism or Islam.

3. The conquest of Granada in 1492 completed the conquest of the last Muslim-ruled kingdom on the Iberian Peninsula by Castile and Aragon.

4. The monarchy also used coercive religious policy as part of political and confessional consolidation: Jews were ordered to convert or leave Castile and Aragon in 1492; Muslims in Castile were later compelled to convert or leave in 1502, with similar coercive measures extended to the Crown of Aragon in 1526.

5. Spain's later Golden Age joined imperial wealth and military power to major achievements in architecture, painting, and literature, including El Escorial, El Greco, and Miguel de Cervantes's Don Quixote.

Architecture: It was not just a palace, but also a religious site for kings to devote themselves to religion in the context of the strong church-state alliance that Spain had become.

Painting: Spain also produced a number of excellent painters. The most famous was El Greco.

Literature: Spain's most famous cultural achievement was Miguel de Cervantes's Don Quixote.

El Escorial — Spain



← Sixteenth-century royal monastery and palace built for Philip II. This later building illustrates the continuing union of monarchy and religion; it is not a building from Ferdinand and Isabella's reign.

El Greco, View of Toledo



Ca. 1599–1600; oil on canvas. The Metropolitan Museum of Art. A late-sixteenth-century view of the Spanish city of Toledo.

https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/436575

FRANCE

1. France was also centralizing its power. Louis XI (r. 1461–1483) reduced the independence of powerful nobles, expanded royal taxation, and strengthened a royally controlled military.

2. The major settlement giving the French crown extensive influence over appointments to bishoprics and abbeys was not made by Louis XI. It was the Concordat of Bologna (1516), concluded by Francis I and Pope Leo X. France remained Catholic while the monarchy gained greater control over the French church.

3. This tradition of substantial French crown influence within a Catholic church is associated with Gallicanism: France remained in communion with Rome while asserting significant local and royal authority.

ENGLAND

1. Soon afterwards, England saw its own period of centralization beginning with Henry VII (r. 1485–1509), who established the Tudor dynasty after the Wars of the Roses.

2. Henry VII restrained the military independence of great nobles, strengthened royal administration and finance, and ruled within England's continuing common-law and parliamentary institutions.

And he rallied support for his moves by claiming that he was doing all this for the good of common Englishmen. This royal move—to appeal to the common people against the nobility—would become increasingly important as the modern era saw the growth and consolidation of royal power in Western Europe.

CUE / CONCEPT	OPTIONAL NOTES
Holy Roman Empire / Habsburgs How did the dynasty grow? Why no centralized Germany?	•
Spain — Ferdinand & Isabella Union, institutions, religion, 1492	•
France — Louis XI / Francis I centralization, Concordat of Bologna, Gallicanism	•
England — Henry VII Tudors, nobles, administration, parliamentary/common-law limits	•

8. Habsburg dynasty
9. Ferdinand and Isabella
10. El Escorial
11. El Greco
12. Miguel de Cervantes
13. Don Quixote
14. Gallicanism
15. Henry VII
16. House of Tudor

SUMMARY

5. England under Henry VII and France under Louis XI both weakened powerful nobles and strengthened royal government, though their institutions and fiscal powers differed.

6. Ferdinand and Isabella joined Castile and Aragon dynastically and strengthened royal and confessional authority, but their realms retained distinct laws and institutions.

7. Habsburg marriage, inheritance, and election greatly expanded dynastic power, but did not transform the Holy Roman Empire into a centralized German state.

Palmer & Colton Reading and Evidence Questions — The New Monarchies

II. The New Monarchies — P&C pp. 67–74

COUNTRY TABLE — For each country, write one phrase under "How power was strengthened" and one under "Important limit." Discuss Questions 6–9.

Case	Problem / starting point	How power was strengthened	Important limit or qualification
England — Henry VII			
France — Louis XI; Francis I			
Spain — Ferdinand & Isabella			
Holy Roman Empire — Habsburgs			

6. England and France: identify one similarity in how Henry VII and Louis XI strengthened monarchy and one difference in the political constraints they faced.

7. France: why is it historically important to distinguish Louis XI from Francis I when discussing control over the French church?

8. Spain: why does Palmer & Colton say "strictly speaking, there was no kingdom of Spain" at this point? Give two pieces of evidence from the reading.

9. Holy Roman Empire: why did Habsburg dynastic success not automatically create a centralized German state?

WRITING PRACTICE — Choose Question 6 or 8. Write one comparison claim and one short evidence fact for each side.

HOMEWORK — for Wednesday October 21 review: Study for Monday's quiz using 002SG1 and corrected 002C.1–3 notes. No new pages and no written study-guide assignment. Wednesday's review is the projected oral Flippity game. QUIZ: Monday October 26, 15 minutes, 12 core points + 1 optional bonus, closed notes.

QUIZ NOTICE — Monday 10/26:

> 002Q: printing; Erasmus/Christian humanism; Faust; Cusa and limited human creativity; North/Italy emphasis; infantry; Ferdinand and Isabella; Habsburg dynasty versus imperial centralization; charters; limits on stronger monarchy; one Northern/New Monarchy comparison.
>
> 10 MC + one 2-point response; 12 core points + 1 optional bonus; 15 minutes; closed notes.

Sources: Palmer & Colton, A History of the Modern World, 8th ed., pp. 62–74.